

STATS AND FACTS

Ornithomimus had a toothless beak, which tells us that it was probably a herbivore but may have also eaten some small animals and insects. Fossils of some ornithomimids suggest that they swallowed stones to help break down tough plant matter in their stomach.

WEIGHT

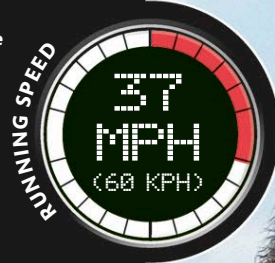


Ornithomimus weighed about 375 lb (170 kg), while the largest ornithomimid, *Gallimimus*, weighed 970 lb (440 kg).

HOLLOW BONES



Ornithomimids had hollow bones, much like modern-day birds, which made them very light.



A birdlike, toothless beak helped *Ornithomimus* crop vegetation with ease.

Built for speed

Fossils of ornithomimid skeletons show several characteristics that suggest these creatures were fast runners. Like modern ostriches, the long limbs of these dinosaurs gave them a lengthy stride. The bones of their feet were strongly built to absorb the impact of running at speed.

Most of *Ornithomimus*'s body was covered in fine, fuzzlike feathers.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 10-13 ft (3-4 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 72-66 MYA
- **HABITAT** Open plains and riverbanks

